

III. Modern History of India

The Advent of European Companies

***Vasco da Gama** was led by a Gujarati guide named **Ahmad ibn Majid** arrived at Calicut, a port situated on the Indian Western Coast, on 20 May 1498 A.D. He had successfully discovered a new and alternative sea route to India from Europe. Zamorin (Zamorin was the ancestral title of the rulers of Calicut), the then ruler of Calicut, welcomed Vasco da Gama. The arrival of Vasco da Gama in India started a new era of trade between Portuguese and Indians. Vasco da Gama made 60 times more profit in the business of Black Pepper which was enough to lure other merchants to India.

*In 1505 A.D., **Francisco de Almeida** arrived in India as first **Portuguese Governor and Viceroy**. In the light of Portuguese trade interests and to establish Portuguese authority in the Indian Ocean, Almeida rendered the **Blue Water Policy**. ***Afonso de Albuquerque** came as the Governor in 1509 A.D. after Almeida. In 1510 A.D., he snatched Goa from Yusuf Adil Shah, the ruler of Bijapur, and established his authority there. He is known as the real founder of the Portuguese power in India. *Albuquerque in 1511 A.D. captured **Malacca**, an important South-East Asian Market and, in 1515, captured **Hormuz** situated at the mouth of Persian Gulf. ***Nuno da Cunha** assumed the Governor office after Lopo Vaz de Sampaio in 1529 A.D. and remained the Governor until the end of 1538 A.D. *A new sea route to India was discovered by Portuguese traveller **Vasco da Gama** whereas Columbus, a traveller originally from Italy and financed by Spain discovered America. **Captain Cook** of Britain discovered a route to Australia and **Tasman** of Holland discovered **Van Diemen's Land** (currently Tasmania) and **New Zealand**. *In 1503, at Cochin, first Portuguese Fort (first European Fort in India) was constructed by Afonso de Albuquerque [he was not Viceroy (Governor) then]. *Portuguese were the first to establish trade relations with India during medieval times. *The sequence of Arrival of European Companies to India is : **Portuguese, Dutch, English, Danes and French**. *Portuguese were the first to arrive in **1498 A.D.** and were last to leave India in **1961**. *In 1961 the Portuguese Governor-General of Goa was **Manuel Antonio Vassalo e Silva** (1958-61 A.D.). ***Jose Ferreira Bossa** was the Governor-General of Goa when India gained Independence in 1947. *Among all European powers, Portuguese were the first to establish Sea trading centers in India.

*Portuguese in 1500 A.D. established their first factory at Calicut. *In 1534 A.D., Portuguese successfully obtained

permission from the ruler of Bengal **Ghiyasuddin Mahmud Shah** to open factories at **Satgaon** and **Chatgaon**. *Hooghly was used as a base by Portuguese for plundering activities in the Bay of Bengal. *In 1632 A.D., Mughal king Shahjahan completely destroyed all the establishments of Portuguese in Hooghly and imprisoned thousands of Portuguese residents. ***Job Charnock**, head of the factory of Qasim Bazar, selected Sutanuti (a place in Calcutta) instead at Hooghly for English Trading Center. This is how he established Calcutta as a Base of Englishmen. * In 1602 A.D., by a resolution passed by Dutch (Holland) Parliament a United East India Company was established. It had a Capital of 6,500,000 Guilders. This company had a monopoly to do trade and to attack and win territories in India and eastern countries. Its eastern centre was situated in **Batavia** (currently Jakarta). Eastern Empire of Dutch was operated and administered by this company. Its partners worked as a private group. Dutch constructed William Fort at Modern Kochi in 1663 A.D. after defeating Portuguese. Kochi in 1814 AD was included in British settlements. *In 1600 A.D., a trading company **English East India Company** or '**The Governor and Company of Merchants of London Trading into the East Indies**' was founded in England. ***Akbar** was the King of India then. ***Levant Company** in 1592 A.D. received Charter for land trade with India. *During the Reign of Jahangir, in **1611 A.D.**, East India Company established its first temporary factory at **Masulipatnam**. In **1613 A.D.**, English established their first permanent factory at **Surat**. *Dutch established their factory at Surat in **1616 A.D.** followed by French in **1668 A.D.**. *Thomas Best was the English officer who defeated Portuguese at a place named **Swally**. *In 1662 A.D., King of Britain Charles II married Portuguese Princess Catherine and received Mumbai as a gift which was leased to East India Company on payment of **10 Pound annually**. *English Governor of Bombay **John Child**, in 1688 A.D., surrounded Mughal ports in Bombay and other Mughal ports on the western coast and tried to imprison Hajj travellers going to Mecca as a result of which Aurangzeb expelled him from India. ***First Carnatic War (1746-48 A.D.)** was just an extension of the War of Succession in Austria which started in 1740. *In 1746 English and French started war without the consent of their home nations in India. English army under the leadership of Captain Bernett seized French Ships, this was the immediate reason for war. During the first Carnatic War, the Nawab of Carnatic, **Anwaruddin**, sent an Army of 10,000 men under the leadership of **Mahfooz Khan** to attack French. Under the leadership of Captain Paradise, the French defeated the Force of Nawab at a place called **St. Thome** on the bank of Adyar

River. With the end of the war in Europe, the war in India also ended with the **Treaty of Aix - la - Chapelle (1748 A.D.)**. Austrian Succession war ended and Madras was again granted to English. ***Dupleix** for the first time used tactics that guided the future campaigns of English men. It was Dupleix who appointed European forces into Indian Courts on Indian expense and interfered in the internal conflicts of kingdoms in the light of European interests and sown the seeds of European rule in India. ***Colbert**, a minister of **Louis XIV**, founded **French East India Company** in 1664 A.D. which is also known as **Compagnie Francaise Pour le Commerce des Indes Orientales**. All its expenditure was sustained by the State. In 1667 A.D. Francois Caron headed an expedition to India setting up a factory in Surat in 1668 A.D. Marcara, a Persian who accompanied Caron founded another French factory in Masulipatnam in 1669 A.D. after obtaining permission from the Sultan of Golconda. *Dutch established their first factory at **Masulipatnam**. In Bengal, they established their first factory at **Pipali**. The trade with Bengal started properly when Dutch in 1653 A.D. established their factory in **Chinsurah**. In Chinsurah, the Dutch fort was called Gustavus Fort.* Europeans obtained high-grade opium and Saltpetre from Bihar. Bihar was famous for opium production during British rule.

The chronology of arrivals of European powers in India is as follows – Portuguese, Dutch, English, Danes and French respectively.

1. In which year Vasco-da-Gama arrived at Calicut ?

- (a) 1350 A.D. (b) 1498 A.D.
(c) 1530 A.D. (d) 1612 A.D.

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (b)

Vasco da Gama arrived at western coast port of Calicut on May 20, 1498 A.D. He discovered a new and alternative sea route to India and he was welcomed by Zamorin (Zamorin was the ancestral title of the rulers of Calicut), the then king of Calicut. The voyage of Vasco da Gama opened the new trade dimensions of the Indo-Portuguese alliance. Vasco da Gama earned 60 times more profit in Europe from black pepper trade with India, which encouraged other Portuguese traders. The Portuguese merchants established their commercial firms in India at the ports of Calicut, Goa, Daman, Diu and Hooghly. Francisco de Almeida came to India in 1505 AD as the first Portuguese Governor and Viceroy. The 'Blue Water' policy is attributed to Francisco de Almeida, the first Viceroy of Portuguese possessions in India. According to Blue water policy, "The Portuguese should be the sole trade power in the Arabian Sea and the Indian Ocean". Albuquerque came to India in 1509 A.D. after him, as a new Viceroy. He annexed Goa in 1510 A.D. from Bijapur ruler Yusuf Adil Shah. The Portuguese maintained Goa as the epicentre of their culture and entity.

2. Which of the following is/are true about Vasco da Gama?

- (i) Zamorin (Samuthiri) was the ruler of Calicut during Vasco Da Gama's trip to India in 1498.
(ii) In his first trip Vasco da Gama stayed for approximately one year in India.
(iii) Vasco Da gama revisited India in 1501.
(a) (i), (ii) and (iii) (b) (i) and (ii)
(c) (i) and (iii) (d) Only (i)

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Ans. (d)

In 1498, Vasco da Gama reached Calicut. At that time, Calicut was ruled by Jamorin (Samuthiri), who welcomed Vasco da Gama. He stayed in India for about three months and returned to Portugal with ships loaded with Indian goods. Vasco da Gama revisited India in 1502 A.D. The Chhattisgarh Public Service Commission has identified option (c) at the correct one in its model answer key.

3. Which one of the following is connected with 'Blue Water' policy?

- (a) De Almeida (b) Albuquerque
(c) Dupleix (d) Robert Clive

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

4. When did Vasco-da-Gama come to India?

- (a) 1496 (b) 1497
(c) 1498 (d) 1600

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

5. Who was the first Portuguese Viceroy in India?

- (a) Diaz (b) Vasco da Gama
(c) Almeida (d) Albuquerque

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

6. Who among the following had welcomed Vasco da Gama at Calicut?

- (a) Gaspar Correa (b) Albuquerque
(c) Zamorin (d) Don Ahnaida

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

7. Who among the following visitors to India did not belong to Portuguese country?

- (a) Duarte Barbosa (b) Domingo Paes
(c) Peter Mundy (d) Fernao Nuniz

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre.) 2021

Ans (c)

Peter Mundy was a 17th century British traveller who came to India during the Mughal rule (Shah Jahan).

8. Match List- I and List- II and select the correct answer from the code given below :

List- I (Voyagers)	List- II (Countries)
A. Vasco da Gama	1. Spain
B. Christopher Columbus	2. Portugal
C. Captain Cook	3. Holland
D. Tasman	4. Great Britain

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	3	2	1	4
(b)	2	1	4	3
(c)	1	4	3	2
(d)	4	3	2	1

I.A.S. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

The Portuguese voyager Vasco da Gama discovered the Indian route. The Columbus, a traveler originally from Italy and financed by Spain discovered America. The British Captain Cook explored Australia while Holland voyager Tasman explored Van Diemen's land (now Tasmania) and New Zealand.

9. Correctly match the following :

A. Afonso de Albuquerque	(i) Change of Portuguese headquarter from Cochin to Goa
B. Nuno da Cunha	(ii) Arrival in India in September 1500 AD
C. Pedro Alvares Cabral	(iii) Blue Water Policy
D. Francisco de Almeida	(iv) Acquiring Goa in 1510 AD

Code :

A	B	C	D
(a) (i)	(ii)	(iv)	(iii)
(b) (iv)	(i)	(ii)	(iii)
(c) (i)	(iv)	(ii)	(iii)
(d) (iv)	(i)	(iii)	(ii)

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

Correctly matched are :

Afonso de Albuquerque	Acquiring Goa in 1510 AD
Nuno da Cunha	Change of Portuguese headquarter from Cochin to Goa
Pedro Alvares Cabral	Arrival in India in September 1500 AD
Francisco de Almeida	Blue Water Policy

10. Match List-I with List-II :

List- I (Explorer)	List-II (Birthplace)
A. Christopher Columbus	1. Portugal
B. Jacques Cartier	2. United Kingdom
C. Sir Francis Drake	3. Italy
D. Ferdinand Magellan	4. France

Select the correct answer using the codes given below

A	B	C	D
(a) 3	4	2	1
(b) 1	2	4	3
(c) 3	4	1	2
(d) 1	4	2	3

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

The correct match is as follows :-

Christopher Columbus	–	Italy
Jacques Cartier	–	France
Sir Francis Drake	–	UK
Ferdinand Magellan	–	Portugal

11. Who were the first Europeans to come to India for trade?

- (a) Dutch (b) English
(c) French (d) Portuguese

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

U.P. P.C.S. (Spl.) (Mains) 2004

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2000

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (d)

The Portuguese were the first Europeans, who came to India during medieval period for trade. The first Portuguese and European voyager Vasco da Gama reached the coast of Calicut in 1498 AD after a long voyage with the help of a Gujarati route guide Ahmad ibn Majid. The sequence of the arrival of the European trade powers in India is as follows: Portuguese, the Dutch, the English, the Danes and French. Portuguese came to India in 1498 and returned in 1961 (longest period).

12. Who was the real founder of Portuguese power in India?

- (a) Vasco da Gama (b) Albuquerque
(c) Bartholomeu Dias (d) George Oxdone

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (b)

The real founder of Portuguese power in India was Albuquerque (1509-15 A.D.). He established Portuguese State as a powerful regional power in India. The annexation of Goa from the Sultan of Bijapur in November, 1510 was the first significant achievement of Albuquerque. The victory at Goa consolidated the Portuguese monopoly on the southern-western naval coast and established a regional Portuguese State in India. He encouraged Portuguese men to marry Indian women for enhancement of the Portuguese presence in India and the formation of permanent colonies.

13. With reference to the entry of European powers into India, which one of the following statements is not correct?

- (a) The Portuguese captured Goa in 1499
(b) The English opened their first factory in South India at Masulipatnam
(c) In Eastern India, the English company opened its first factory in Orissa in 1633
(d) Under the leadership of Dupleix, the French occupied Madras in 1746

I.A.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (a)

The Portuguese Viceroy Albuquerque captured Goa from the Sultan of Bijapur in 1510 A.D. Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.

14. At which one of the following places in India did the Portuguese build their first fortress?

- (a) Anjediva (b) Cannanore
(c) Cochin (d) Goa

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (c)

The first Portuguese fortress was built by Afonso-de-Albuquerque (who was not the Viceroy at that time) in Cochin in 1503. Francisco de Almeida constructed the Portuguese fortress in Cannanore and Anjediva in 1505.

15. Who were the first Europeans to set up sea trade centres in India?

- (a) The English (b) The French
(c) The Portuguese (d) The Dutch

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

Among all European powers in India, the Portuguese traders were the first to establish maritime trade centers in India. The first Portuguese Viceroy Francisco de Almeida annexed Diu in 1509 A.D. The victory of Diu made Portuguese most powerful in the Indian Ocean. The Portuguese established their monopoly over the Indian Ocean and levied a tax on ships passing through their area.

16. Among the following factories in Bengal, the one established by the Portuguese was :

- (a) Bandel (b) Chinsurah
(c) Hooghly (d) Shrirampur

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

In 1534 AD. the Portuguese obtained permission to establish their factories in Satgaon and Chatgaon from the then ruler of Bengal, Ghiyasuddin Mahmud Shah. After that, Portuguese colonies were set up through Bengal. Chatgaon, known as the great port of Portuguese maritime, was used by them but in the 16th century Satgaon declined and was replaced by Hooghly. Dutch built a fort named Fort Gustavus in Chinsurah. Shrirampur was a major centre of Danes.

17. With reference to Pondicherry (Now Puducherry), consider the following statements:

- The first European power to occupy Pondicherry were the Portuguese.
- The second European power to occupy Pondicherry were the French.
- The English never occupied Pondicherry.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (a)

The first European powers to occupy Pondicherry (now Puducherry) and to exert power in India was the Portuguese. Dutch was the second European power to occupy Pondicherry. The Britishers also occupied Pondicherry in 1793 but handed it over to France in 1814 as per the Treaty of Paris. Thus, only statement (1) is correct.

18. Hooghly was used as a base for piracy in the Bay of Bengal by :

- (a) Portuguese (b) French
(c) Danish (d) British

I.A.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (a)

The Portuguese used Hooghly as a base for piracy in the Bay of Bengal. In 1632 A.D., Qasim Khan who was the Governor of Bengal during Shahjahan's reign finally subdued and imprisoned thousands of Portuguese.

19. Who used Hooghly as a base for piracy in the Bay of Bengal?

- (a) The Dutch
- (b) The French
- (c) The Portuguese
- (d) The British
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

20. Who among the following was the founder of Calcutta?

- (a) Charles Ayar
- (b) Job Charnock
- (c) Garold Angiyar
- (d) William Novris

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

Ans. (b)

The Chief of Qasim Bazar factory, Job Charnock had selected Sutanuti or Sutnauti (Calcutta) instead of Hooghly for the establishment of the British trade centre and finally he founded Kolkata in the form of English colonies.

21. Who founded Calcutta?

- (a) John Surman
- (b) Vasco da Gama
- (c) Warren Hastings
- (d) Job Charnock

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

22. In India the First Municipal Corporation was set up in which one among the following places?

- (a) Calcutta
- (b) Madras
- (c) Bombay
- (d) Delhi

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

The First Municipal Corporation in Modern India was established in 1688 AD in the former Presidency city of Madras.

23. The first to start a joint stock company to trade with India were :

- (a) Portuguese
- (b) Dutch
- (c) French
- (d) Danish

I.A.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

The First joint stock company for trade with India was the English East India company, established in London in 1600 A.D. After this, a Joint Dutch East India company was established by a resolution passed by the Dutch parliament in 1602 A.D. Since Britain is not in the question option, the answer will be option (b).

24. Which one of the following is the correct statement?

- (a) The modern Kochi was a Dutch colony till India's Independence.
- (b) The Dutch defeated the Portuguese and built Fort Williams in the modern Kochi.
- (c) The modern Kochi was first a Dutch Colony before the Portuguese took over from them.
- (d) The modern Kochi never became a part of the British colony.

I.A.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

The Dutch defeated the Portuguese and built Williams Fort in Modern Kochi in 1663 A.D. (now in Thrissur district of Kerala). Kochi was included in the British colonial region in 1814. Thus, option (b) is the correct answer.

25. With reference to Indian history, consider the following statements :

1. The Dutch established their factories/warehouses on the east coast on lands granted to them by Gajapati rulers.
2. Alfonso de Albuquerque captured Goa from the Bijapur Sultanate.
3. The English East India Company established a factory at Madras on a plot of land leased from a representative of the Vijayanagara empire.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

Dutch snatched Cochin (Kochi) from Portuguese at east coast and later established their factories on the coast of Andhra and Odisha in 17th century, while the rule of Gajapati rulers was declined by 16th century. Hence, option (1) is wrong. Albuquerque annexed Goa from Bijapur sultanate in 1510 A.D, hence, statement (2) is right. East India company established a factory at Madras by taking the lease of a plot of land from representative of Vijayanagara Empire. Hence, statement (3) is also right.

26. The secret of success of East India Company in India was :

- (a) Absence of Nationalism in India
- (b) The company army received western training and they had modern arms.
- (c) Indian Soldiers lacked fidelity consequently the one who paid them sufficient could have them on his service
- (d) All the above three

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

All the three factors were helpful in the success of East India Company in India. It is known that a group called Merchants Adventures in England formed East India company or 'The Governor and company of Merchants of London trading into the East Indies.' In December 1600, Queen Elizabeth I of England granted a royal charter to do business with the East Indies.

27. Which of the following British companies got the first charter permitting them to trade in India?

- (a) Levant Company
- (b) East India Company
- (c) The English Company trading to the East Indies
- (d) Ostend Company

U.P.P.S.C. (R.I.) 2014

Ans. (a)

The Levant Company, in 1592 A.D. had got a charter for trading with India by land routes. British Queen Elizabeth I granted a charter to an English company trading to the East Indies by sea route on December 31, 1600 A.D. This company extended its trade with the merger of a new company in 1708 A.D. under the new name of "United Company of Merchants of England Trading to the East Indies," which was later known as "East India Company".

28. Which one of the following was the Emperor of India when the British East India Company was formed in London?

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Jahangir
- (c) Shahjahan
- (d) Aurangzeb

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

U. P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a)

Plans were prepared by some merchants for trading with eastern islands, so a company for the fulfilment of this purpose was founded in 1600 A.D., named as The Governor and Company of Merchants of London Trading into the East Indies. At that time, Akbar was the Emperor of India (1556-1605 A.D.).

29. During the time of which Mughal Emperor did the English East India Company establish its first factory in India?

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Jahangir
- (c) Shahjahan
- (d) Aurangzeb

I.A.S. (Pre) 2009

I.A.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

The English East India Company established its first temporary factory in India during the reign of Mughal Emperor Jahangir in Masulipatnam, in 1611 A.D. The first permanent British factory was established at Surat in 1613 A.D.

30. Where in India did Britishers set up their first factory in 1613?

- (a) Goa
- (b) Hooghly in Bengal
- (c) Amarkot
- (d) Surat

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

Captain William Hawkins reached Mughal Court from Surat in April 1609 AD but did not succeed in getting permission to set up a factory. Despite Portuguese antagonism, Captain Middleton landed at Swally near Surat and succeeded in getting permission for trade from the Mughal Governor in 1611 A.D. Captain Thomas Best dissolved the Portuguese monopoly with the victory at Swally. Consequently, the British established a permanent factory in 1613 A.D. They expanded their trade to other parts of India and established cooperative factories in Ahmedabad, Burhanpur, Ajmer and Agra immediately.

31. The first factory of the East India Company was established at –

- (a) Pune
- (b) Goa
- (c) Pondicherry
- (d) Surat

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

32. Which of the British officials defeated Portuguese at Swally?

- (a) William Hawkins
- (b) Thomas Best
- (c) Thomas Roe
- (d) Josiah Child

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

Captain Thomas Best defeated Portuguese in 1612 A.D. in the naval battle of Swally near modern Surat city.

33. With reference to the Captain Hawkins, which of the following statements is correct?

- (1) He came to India in 1611 as an envoy of James-I.
(2) He was very well versed in Turkish language.

- (a) Both (1) and (2) (b) Only (1)
(c) Neither (1) nor (2) (d) Only (2)

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (d)

William Hawkins was the first English ambassador to be sent by the East India Company to the Mughal court of Jahangir in 1608 A.D. He reached in the Mughal court in 1609. Hence, statement (1) is incorrect. He had knowledge of Turkish language. He spoke Turkish very well. Hence statement (2) is correct. Thus option (d) is correct answer.

34. In the first quarter of seventeenth century, in which of the following was/were the factory/factories of the English East India Company located?

1. Broach
2. Chicacole
3. Trichinopoly

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2
(c) 3 only (d) 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre.) 2021

Ans (a)

Establishment of Factories by East India Company in first quarter of 17th century -

- Surat in 1613
- Agra, Ahmedabad, Baroda and Broach by 1619.
- Masulipatnam in 1611 and Armagaon in 1628.
- Hariharpur and Balasore (in Odisha) in 1633.

35. Which one of the following European trading company was the first to establish its factory at Surat?

- (a) The Dutch (b) The English
(c) The French (d) The Portuguese

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011

Ans. (b)

The British East India Company was the first to establish its factory at Surat among all European trade companies. Jahangir granted permission to the British to set up a permanent factory at Surat, in 1613. The Dutch established a factory in Surat in the year 1616, while the French did so in the year 1668.

36. In the year 1613, where was the English East India Company given permission to set up a factory (trading post)?

- (a) Bangalore (b) Madras
(c) Masulipattam (d) Surat

I.A.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (d)

In the year 1613, the English East India Company was permitted to set up a factory (trading post) in Surat.

37. Where was the Western Presidency situated in the early period of the East India Company?

- (a) Surat (b) Satara
(c) Bombay (d) Panaji

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (a)

The East India Company initially made Surat, its western Presidency. Later, it was shifted to Bombay.

38. Bombay was taken over by the English East India Company from –

- (a) The Dutch (b) The French
(c) The Danish (d) The Portuguese

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (d)

Bombay was given as a dowry gift by the Portuguese Crown to the British when Charles II, the King of England married Catherine of Braganza, the Princess of Portugal in 1662 A.D. Charles II gave Bombay to British East India Company on 10-pound annual rent in 1668.

39. In which of the following year, was the authority of the British established over the fort of Prayagraj (U.P.)?

- (a) 1790 A.D. (b) 1792 A.D.
(c) 1796 A.D. (d) 1797 A.D.

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (*)

Nawab Saadat Ali Khan II of Awadh handed over the Fort of Prayagraj (Allahabad) to the British in 1798 AD.

40. Which English Governor of East India Company in India was expelled by Aurangzeb -

- (a) Aungier (b) Sir John Child
(c) Sir John Gayer (d) Sir Nicholas Waite

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

The British Governor of Bombay, John Child, cordoned off Mughal ports of Bombay and western coastal areas in 1688 and tried to capture Mecca pilgrims. As a result, Aurangzeb ordered his expulsion from India. He was forced to negotiate for peace and bent to his knees before the Mughal Emperor.

41. Which one of the following was the immediate cause of the First Carnatic War?

- (a) Anglo-French Rivalry
(b) Austrian War of Succession

- (c) Issues of Carnatic Succession
(d) Capture of French ships by the British

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (d)

The First Carnatic War (1746-48 A.D.) was an offshoot of the Anglo-French rivalry in the Austrian War of succession that took place in Europe in 1740 AD. The British Captain Barnett captured some French ships which became the immediate cause of the war. Nawab Anwaruddin sent an army under the command of Mahfooz Khan to besiege the French in Madras during the first Carnatic War. The French Army (under the command of Captain Paradise) defeated Nawab's Army at the Battle of St. Thome near Adyar river. Treaty of Aix-La-Chapelle (18 Oct, 1748 A.D.) ended the War of Austrian succession and with it first Carnatic War ended and the Britishers reoccupied Madras. The first Carnatic War is memorable for the War of St. Thome.

42. Carnatic War was fought between :

- (a) English and French (b) English and Dutch
(c) English and Marathas (d) Haider Ali and Marathas

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

43. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists:

List-I	List-II
A. First Carnatic War	1. Ended by Treaty of Paris
B. Third Carnatic War	2. Britishers Lost
C. Second Carnatic War	3. Inconclusive War
D. First Mysore War	4. Ended by Treaty of Aix La Chapelle

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	3	4	2
(b)	2	4	1	3
(c)	4	1	3	2
(d)	3	1	4	2

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

The correctly matched list is as follows:

List- I	List- II
First Carnatic War	- Ended by Treaty of Aix-La-Chapelle
Third Carnatic War	- Ended by Treaty of Paris
Second Carnatic War	- Inconclusive War
First Mysore War	- Britishers lost

44. Which one of the following is not correctly matched?

- (a) First battle of Karnataka – 1746-48
(b) Second battle of Karnataka – 1750-52
(c) Third battle of Karnataka – 1758-63
(d) Third battle of Panipat – 1761

U.P. G.I.C. 2017

Ans. (b)

The correct match is as follows :

First battle of Karnataka	–	1746-48
Second battle of Karnataka	–	1749-54
Third battle of Karnataka	–	1758-63
Third battle of Panipat	–	1761

45. What is/are not true in relation to 'Battle of Ambur'?

- (i) This battle was fought in 1752.
(ii) In this battle, armies of Muzaffarjang, Chanda Sahib and French fought together against Anwar-ud-din.
(iii) In this battle, army of Anwar-ud-din had to face defeat.

- (a) (ii) and (iii) (b) (i) and (iii)
(c) (i) and (ii) (d) Only (i)

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (d)

The Battle of Ambur in 1749 A.D. was the first major war of the second carnatic war. The battle was initiated by Muzaffarjang and supported by Joseph Francois Dupleix and led by Chanda Sahib, who sought to overthrow Anwar-ud-din Khan, the Nawab of the carnatic, for supporting Nasir Jang claim to be Nizam of Hyderabad. In this battle, army of Anwar-ud-din had to face defeat. Anwar-ud-din Khan was killed in the battle and Chanda Sahib siezed control of the carnatic.

46. Who among the following was the first European to initiate the policy of taking part in the quarrels of Indian Princess with a view to acquire territories?

- (a) Clive (b) Dupleix
(c) Albuquerque (d) Warren Hastings

I.A.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (b)

Dupleix initiated the tactics that were later adopted by English to conquer India. For the first time, it was Dupleix who deployed the European Army to the Indian courts at the expense of Indian kings. He intervened in Indian politics for European advantage.

47. In India, among the following locations, the French established their earliest factory at :

- (a) Surat (b) Pulicat
(c) Cochin (d) Qasim Bazar

I.A.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (a)

Louis XIV's Finance Minister Colbert formed a French East India company named 'Compagnie Francaise Pour le Commerce des Indes Orientales' in 1664 A.D. The Company was thus created and financed by the State. The company undertook a fresh expedition in 1667 A.D. under the command of Francois Caron and set up the first French factory at Surat in 1668.

48. French East India Company was constituted during the reign of-

- (a) Louis XIV (b) Louis XIII
(c) Louis XV (d) Louis XVI

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

49. Who among the following is considered the founder of French Company in India :

- (a) Richelieu (b) Mazarin
(c) Colbert (d) Franco Martin

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2003

Ans. (c)

The Company "Compagnie Francaise Pour le Commerce des Indes Orientales" was established on the recommendation of Colbert in 1664 A.D. He is considered the founder of the French Company in India.

50. Which of the following factories of Bengal was established by the Dutch?

- (a) Bandel (b) Chinsurah
(c) Hooghly (d) Srirampur

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2010

Ans. (b) & (c)

The First Dutch Company in Bengal was set up in Pipali (1627 A.D.). A few days later, the Dutch moved towards Balasore from Pipali, but the trade of the Dutch started in Bengal in 1635 A.D. and continued till 1656 A.D. at a factory in Hooghly. After 1656 A.D. a factory at Chinsurah village in Hooghly, which was established in 1653 A.D. became their important trading point. From the options, it's clear that Dutch's factories were established at Chinsurah (village in Hooghly) along with at Hooghly headquarter. Till the end of 17th century, Dutch companies were established at Qasim Bazar, Patna, Dhaka, Malda, Balasore, etc.

51. Dutch East India company established its factory at Patna in which year?

- (a) 1601 (b) 1632
(c) 1774 (d) 1651
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (b)

Dutch East India Company entered Patna in 1632, however there is no clear authentic sources claiming establishment of Dutch factory in Patna in 1632 AD. Although historian Om Prakash has given proofs for establishment of a Dutch factory in Patna in 1638 AD which was closed down the same year due to financial problems.

52. The Dutch East India Company established its factory at Patna in which year?

- (a) 1635 (b) 1632
(c) 1643 (d) 1648

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

53. Match the following Dutch factories with their years of establishment :

- A. Bimlipatam (i) 1653
B. Karaikal (ii) 1645
C. Cochin (iii) 1641
D. Chinsura (iv) 1663

Code :

- | A | B | C | D |
|-----------|------|-------|-------|
| (a) (i) | (ii) | (iv) | (iii) |
| (b) (iii) | (ii) | (iv) | (i) |
| (c) (iii) | (iv) | (ii) | (i) |
| (d) (i) | (ii) | (iii) | (iv) |

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

Dutch factories with their years of establishment –

Place	Year
Bimlipatam	1641 AD
Karaikal	1645 AD
Cochin	1663 AD
Chinsura	1653 AD

54. The French failed to establish power in the Deccan because:

- (a) Duplex was not a capable general
(b) The English had a strong army
(c) The French were not liked by the Indians
(d) Pondicherry was not a strategic centre

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (b)

One major cause of French failure in India was their weak naval strength. According to Voltaire, during the war of Austrian succession, the French naval strength was reduced so badly that the Navy had hardly any battleship left in the Seven Years War. On the other hand, the British had a strong naval force.

55. The following European Powers entered into Indian trade at one time or the other :

- | | |
|----------------|-------------------|
| 1. The English | 2. The Dutch |
| 3. The French | 4. The Portuguese |

Select the correct chronological order of their entry from the code given below :

Code:

- | | |
|-------------|-------------|
| (a) 1,2,3,4 | (b) 4,2,1,3 |
| (c) 3,4,2,1 | (d) 2,3,4,1 |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

The sequence of the arrival of European powers in India is as follows. Portuguese-Dutch-English--Danes-French.

56. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:

- | List- I | List- II |
|----------------|------------------|
| A. Pondicherry | 1. Dutch |
| B. Goa | 2. French |
| C. Tranquebar | 3. Portuguese |
| D. Sadras | 4. Danish (Dane) |

Code :

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| | A | B | C | D |
| (a) | 2 | 3 | 4 | 1 |
| (b) | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| (c) | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 |
| (d) | 4 | 1 | 2 | 3 |

U.P. R.O./ A.R.O. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

The correctly matched list is as follows :

- | (List-I) | | (List-II) |
|-------------|---|---------------|
| Pondicherry | - | French |
| Goa | - | Portuguese |
| Tranquebar | - | Danish (Dane) |
| Sadras | - | Dutch |

Thus, option (a) is the correct code.

57. Identify the region from where Europeans got best shora (Saltpetre) and opium –

- | | |
|------------|-------------|
| (a) Bihar | (b) Gujarat |
| (c) Bengal | (d) Madras |

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (a)

The Europeans obtained the best shora (Saltpetre) and opium from Bihar.

58. During British rule which region of India was famous for the production of opium?

- | | |
|-------------|--------------------|
| (a) Bihar | (b) Southern India |
| (c) Gujarat | (d) Assam |

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

During British rule, the State of Bihar was famous for the production of opium.

59. What was the chief economic foundation of the triangular commerce between India, China and England?

- | | |
|------------------|--------------------------------|
| (a) Silk | (b) Opium |
| (c) Black pepper | (d) More than one of the above |

70th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (b)

The triangular trade between India, China, and England in the 18th and 19th centuries was centered on opium. The British East India Company cultivated opium in India (mainly Bengal and Bihar) and exported it to China, where it was in high demand despite government bans. Profits from the opium trade were used to purchase Chinese goods like tea, silk, and porcelain for England, while manufactured goods from England were exported to India, completing the trade cycle. This exploitative system had severe social and economic consequences, including the Opium Wars between Britain and China. While commodities like silk and black pepper were also traded, opium was the chief economic foundation of this triangular commerce.

60. Who, among the following Europeans, was the last to come to pre-independence India as traders?

- | | |
|------------|----------------|
| (a) Dutch | (b) English |
| (c) French | (d) Portuguese |

I.A.S. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (c)

The sequence of Europeans who came to Pre-independence India as traders is : Portuguese in 1498, Dutch in 1605 AD, English in 1608 AD and French in 1667 AD. Hence, the last to come to India were French.

61. In which of the following places the Dutch established their trading centre in India?

- | |
|--|
| (a) Nagappattinam, Chinsura, Machilipatnam |
| (b) Surat, Bharuch, Agra |
| (c) Cochin, Ahmedabad, Patna |
| (d) All the above |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (d)

Important trading centers established by Dutch in India were- Nagappattinam. Chinsura, Machilipatnam, Surat, Bharuch, Agra, Kochin, Ahmedabad, Patna.